

GALLATES

What are they?

Gallates (propyl gallate, octyl gallate, and dodecyl gallate) are antioxidants that are added to food or cosmetic products to prevent spoilage and rancidity due to the oxidation of fats and oils.

Where are they found?

Gallates are primarily found in waxy or oily cosmetics and in oily, greasy, or high-fat foods. The following is a list of products that may contain gallates.

Propyl gallate	Octyl gallate	Dodecyl gallate
• Lip gloss, lip balm, lip liner • Moisturizers, creams, lotions, and oils • Eyeliner, brow liner • Eye shadow, mascara • Concealer, compact powder • Bar soap, facial cleanser • Sunscreen, sunblock, tanning oil • Shaving cream • Hair-loss treatment • Skin-fading cream, skin-lightening cream • Antiperspirant, deodorant • Perfume • Foods, as follow: • Vegetable oil/shortening • Meat products • Potato sticks • Chicken soup base • Chewing gum • Dry breakfast cereals	• Foods, as follow: • Margarine • Peanut butter • Beer • Edible oils • Fats, lard, shortening • Mayonnaise • Canned fruits • Salad dressings • Cereals • Dairy products • Snack foods • Processed meats/fish • Some cosmetics • Paints, varnishes • Boot polishes • Plastics • Emulsion waxes • Transformer oils	•Foods, as follow: • Margarine • Mayonnaise • Peanut butter • Cheese

How can they be avoided?

Identification of the specific gallate compound to which the patient has been sensitized can aid in the avoidance of products and foodstuffs that contain it. If there are gallates in the product, they should be indicated on the ingredient list.

If the patient is tested with only one gallate and has a positive reaction, he or she should avoid all gallates because gallates can cross-react. If the patient is tested with all three gallates and reacts to only one of them, the patient needs to avoid only the specific gallate to which he or she reacted.